

CE Info Systems, a Delhi-based company that has been involved in Geographical Information Systems (GIS) development for the past decade.

Says Verma, "I wanted to develop a service that was India-specific. It was originally intended to be an Indian version of Mapquest, but now we're thinking of adding more services relevant to India."

The MapMyIndia team has currently mapped about 35 cities and several villages, with more being added on a weekly basis. The team is also collaborating with state governments to execute the project.

Says Rakesh Verma, MD of CE Info Systems, "We received numerous requests from users and members of the GIS community to prepare an interactive and user-friendly map-based information services."

By making the service available on the Web, MapMyIndia has made it easy for anyone with a PC and an Internet connection to access the information. "We aim to empower anyone who travels within India—be they local residents or business travellers or tourists," affirms Rohan Verma.

MapMyIndia also provides customised solutions for businesses. Displaying the location of a company, bank or hotel on an interactive map could be an attractive value-add for a customer.

Says Verma, "We could extend our GIS services to ATMs, for example. Using the



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Rohan Verma

The brain behind MapMyIndia.com

The screenshot shows the MapMyIndia website interface. At the top, there's a navigation bar with 'HOME', 'BUSINESS SOLUTIONS', and 'CONTACT US'. Below it, a header says 'INDIA...ON A MAP... Like never before'. The main content area has a 'Search a Location' section with input fields for 'Place/City/Street', 'City/Town', 'State', and 'Select State'. There are also links for 'Driving Directions', 'Route Maps', 'Tourist Guide', and 'Business Listing'. On the right, there's a 'Digital Map and Data' section with links to 'National Level Maps of India', 'City Level Maps of India', 'Produce Maps of India', and 'Census and Industry Data'. At the bottom, there's a 'Business Solutions' section with a 'MapmyIndia Business Solutions Suite' link.

The more detailed the query, the better the search results.

MapMyIndia also provides customised business solutions: companies, banks, hotels, and the likes, could be featured on the map of a particular area



Write In

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Store/Enterprise Locator feature on the site, people who are in a particular area can log on and find an ATM."

MapMyIndia will soon also provide business listings, which can help customers identify business districts, restaurants, and so on.

Track Your Team

In 2000, CE Info Systems launched 'Mappls Mumbai Pathfinder' in print and CD-ROM versions, a comprehensive collection of digital maps of localities in Mumbai city. 'Pathfinder' covered over 800 square kilometres of geographical area, demarcated by PIN codes, telephone exchanges, police stations, municipal wards and so on.

The collection is in the form of sectional maps of 15 square kilometres, each linked to the other. The maps depict every street and road in a particular area, including prominent landmarks, offering a magnified view of up to one square kilometre of select localities—and even individual buildings.

Although Pathfinder was a fairly comprehensive undertaking, an online venture, feels Verma, would help a lot more people access and utilise the digital map database. MapMyIndia has now tied up with several corporate organisations, as well as the Government of India, to add more cities, towns and villages to their database.

The company is also planning more features such as car-based navigation systems, and local tracking systems—for parents to track children returning from school with the driver, for example, or a company to track its sales force through mobile phones and other WAP/GPRS enabled devices. These services will be made available to customers via MapMyIndia's "Business Solutions" section.

Stanford Sophomore

Rohan Verma's initial ideation was followed by exhaustive research on the technology backend, the business model, and design specifics. Post the launch, in the first month alone, the Web site registered a million hits—a number that has been steadily on the rise.

The MapMyIndia.com team currently comprises software developers, cartographers and GIS digital experts.

Rohan Verma is currently pursuing a BS in Electrical Engineering at Stanford University in the US. At Stanford, Verma is involved with the Hindi Film Dance club ("There is only one kind of Indian dance out here, and that's the Bollywood kind!"), sports and entrepreneurship cells.

He has earned many accolades, including the 'Best Work Study Student Award' from the Stanford University Registrar (for making the Stanford Bulletin Web site more accessible and Net-friendly), and the President's Award for Academic Excellence in the Freshman Year.

Verma foresees a career in chip design or architecture. "I also want to develop and offer some world class location-based services to people in India," he says. ☒

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Business Solutions

MapmyIndia Business Solutions Suite

Convert online traffic into physical customers.

Where is your business location? How does a potential customer get to your business location? And finally, what is around your business location? MapmyIndia offers location-based business solutions that leverage the reach of the internet to bring potential and existing customers to your business location's doorstep.

Companies looking to improve on their popularity, business and easy accessibility in terms of both the incoming traffic to their websites and/or their outlets can draw benefits from these business solutions.

By letting your customers know where you are and how to get there, you can provide visitors to your website an enriched and more informed online experience, associate yourself with cutting edge high technology, and most importantly, convert online traffic into physical customers by leading web surfers to the doorstep of your physical location.

Looking at the different requirements and interests of different customers, MapmyIndia business solutions offer diverse range of location based products for both online and offline applications.